

Cliff Notes: Chapter 3 Methodology

The design moves from phenomenology and qualitative inquiry to ALPHA, BRAVO, cross-dataset integration, and ethical safeguards.

Purpose

To understand how discipline is conceptualised, operationalised, and experienced in the NSC, and to analyse what this reveals for education and society.

DESIGN

Phenomenological qualitative study

Phenomenology fits because discipline is contested, contextual, embodied, and lived. The qualitative approach allows depth, interaction, and flexible data generation across interviews, focus groups, observations, letters, and paintings.

Temporal Phase ALPHA

RQ1. Interviews and focus groups with instructors and school leaders. Thematic analysis explores how discipline is conceptualised.

POSITION

Insider-outsider reflexivity

The researcher's military career gives insider knowledge, while overseas doctoral research creates analytic distance. Journaling, blogging, reflective pauses, member checking, and ethical self-scrutiny manage the risk of preoccupation and authority.

Temporal Phase BRAVO

RQ2 and RQ3. Interviews, focus groups, observations, letters, and painting workshop examine how discipline is practised and experienced.

SAMPLE

Purposive, information-rich recruitment

Sampling is non-probabilistic and purposive. The study prioritises intensity of contact, saturation, and information-rich participants from CITC and 10th Battalion JNSC, with recruitment designed to protect autonomy.

Cross-dataset integration

Conceptualisation, operationalisation, and experience are read together through ENA, R audit, theory, and hermeneutics.

Research questions mapped to data and analysis

RQ1

How educators conceptualise discipline

RQ2

How educators operationalise discipline

RQ3

How youth experience and perceive discipline

Integration strategy

ENA models patterned code relations. R audits the visual and interactive outputs. Theoretical interpretation uses Behaviourism, Social Cognitive Theory, and Foucauldian Theory as bounded supports. Hermeneutic interpretation moves between parts and whole.

Logistics

Access, recruitment, and integration required planning, communication, flexibility, and reflexive adjustment.

Contribution

The study aims to inform practice, policy, and theory on discipline in education, youth military training, and Jamaican society.

Ethics

BERA alignment, voluntary consent, gatekeepers, civilian dress, and chain-of-command separation reduce coercion risk.